



JUSTIN SCHACTER admires a SuperAdobe during a tour at CalEarth, an educational campus and nonprofit organization in Hesperia.

WILLIAM LIANG For The Times

Why some are looking to build ‘SuperAdobes’

Since the L.A.-area fires in January, interest has increased in earthen architecture that’s resistant to disasters

By Jessie Schiewe

At the southern edge of the Mojave Desert on an unusually warm Saturday in February, dozens of people mill about in the living space of a 2,300-square-foot, three-bed, two-bath house with a connected two-car garage.

A couple gliding past the open kitchen marvel at the room’s “good natural lighting.” In the hallway outside the expansive main bedroom, a tall bearded man compares the space to a “luxury Airbnb experience,” while two grade-school-age boys play with a light switch on the wall, flicking the ceiling fan on and off.

“I’ve never seen a house like this,” one of them says, “but I like the shape of it.”

The house has central heating and air conditioning, a natural gas fireplace and ample closet space. And yet, modern ame-

nities aside, this is no normal home.

Instead of resembling a box, the structure consists of a sequence of vaulted domes nestled together, like a lost cottage straight out of a storybook. The walls are curved and the ceilings are tall and arched. And the entire building is constructed with just a few materials: soil, water, sandbags, barbed wire, plaster and a bit of cement.

But what’s most notable about this structure is something visitors can’t see: The house is capable of withstanding a colossal natural disaster, whether that be a tornado, hurricane, earthquake or fire.

Welcome to Earth One, the piece de resistance at CalEarth, an educational campus and nonprofit organization in Hesperia. [See **Earthen**, A8]

Law that shields migrants is facing new test

SB 54 held up despite efforts to overturn it. Now, Trump allies in California seek to undermine legislation.

By ANDREA CASTILLO

WASHINGTON — Two days after Donald Trump won the 2016 election, California state Senate President Pro Tem Kevin de León canceled a flight to Germany and called his executive staff for a meeting.

They began to dissect the myriad ways Trump could “seriously hurt Californians” through policies and actions on the environment, freedom of choice and immigration.

The framework for landmark legislation on immigration — Senate Bill 54 — was born a few weeks later.

“We knew that we needed to do something to protect immigrants, and it wasn’t just something on a social media platform or a hashtag,” De León recalled. “We needed something with real teeth.”

Across the country, immigration agents rely on state and local law enforcement to help them identify and arrest deportable immigrants. When SB 54 took effect in 2018, California became the first state to substantially divorce its law enforcement resources from federal immigration enforcement use. There were so-called sanctuary cities, but no sanctuary states.

Formally called the California Values Act, SB 54 is crucial to California leaders’ efforts to “Trump-proof” the state. In Trump’s first term, he tried and failed to overturn the law in court, but advocates worry that his new administration will encourage local governments to defy the law and that many residents remain at risk without more stringent protections.

The law is also held up by both supporters and opponents as an example of why sanctuary policies work, or don’t. Its advocates say SB 54 stands out as the single law that has prevented the most deportations anywhere across the country. [See **SB 54**, A10]



CARLIN STIEHL For The Times

AZUSENA FAVELA monitors her community last week for potential activity by federal ICE agents.

Neighborhood patrol is on lookout for ICE and immigrant rights

Coalition’s goal is to spot federal agents in communities and alert locals on social media.

By RUBEN VIVES

Driving north on Griffith Avenue in South Los Angeles on a recent morning, Azusena Favela and Adalberto Ríos kept an eye out for unmarked American-brand vehicles with dark tinted windows and government license plates, anything that may point to the presence of Immigration and Customs Enforcement agents.

As Favela turned left on 23rd Street, she noticed a white truck with yellow

flashing lights stopped near an intersection in the distance.

“Do you see it?” she said. “¿Las luces?” Ríos said. “Yeah.”

Ríos grabbed a two-way radio he had on hand and spoke into it: “What’s your location, Lupe?”

“27th and San Pedro [streets],” she said, amid the static noise.

“We see some lights,” he said. “We’re going to check it out, will let you know if we see anything.”

Across the country, community groups and immigrant rights advocates began preparing for President Trump’s mass deportations by organizing know-your-rights workshops, street demonstrations and legal [See **Patrols**, A12]

Unbuilt Huntington Park pool triggers graft inquiry

By RUBEN VIVES

Back in 2019, plans were announced with much fanfare for an aquatics center with an Olympic-size pool for residents of the working-class city of Huntington

Park. Officials hailed it as a major improvement.

“The aquatic programs will allow the community to unite for play, competition, fitness and learning at all ages. The community swimming programs will create a stronger relationship with

the community, increasing access, public engagement and recruitment into higher education opportunities,” the city said in its announcement.

But six years later, the center has still not been built [See **Pool**, A10]

IT’S SO SAD: Residents rebuke Huntington Park city officials. CALIFORNIA, B1



ALLEN J. SCHABEN Los Angeles Times

SPARKLE AND SUBSTANCE

“The Substance” star and lead actress nominee Demi Moore arrives Sunday at the Academy Awards. Scan this code with your phone to read our eNewspaper special Oscars section.



Musk chaos is a problem for Trump

President cheers him on, but a misstep could spell disaster, writes Doyle McManus. PERSPECTIVES, A2

Watkins makes USC juggernaut

Trojans guard is best women’s basketball player in the country, bar none, writes Bill Plaschke. SPORTS, D1

Weather Sunny and breezy. L.A. Basin: 63/47. B5

For the latest news, go to **latimes.com**.

Printed with soy inks on partially recycled paper.



7 85944 00200 5



Subscribers get more in the app.

Download now to experience all of The Times.

